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PSE Wildfire Season Declaration Procedure

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1 Purpose

This procedure establishes the process and criteria for determining, declaring, and managing the PSE Wildfire Season Status, including the approval and communication requirements for activating, modifying, and rescinding that status. Each PSE Wildfire Season Status change triggers specific mitigation and wildfire preparedness actions. This procedure is a component of the *PSE Wildfire Operating Plan*.

PSE activates Wildfire Season when receptive fuels or weather conditions increase the potential for wildfire activity (see Section 6.1.1). The typical PSE Wildfire Season begins as early as May 1 and concludes by October 15. Wildfire Season typically fluctuates from low fire risk to extreme fire risk throughout the season, often peaking in August.

2 Scope

This procedure applies to all PSE personnel involved in the analysis, decision-making, and implementation of PSE Wildfire Season Status changes and associated mitigation actions. While core decision-making responsibilities are assigned to a specific group of roles, the outcomes of those decisions affect a broad range of company operations.

In-scope personnel include those responsible for:

- Monitoring environmental conditions
- Facilitating and approving status change decisions
- Implementing operational mitigations
- Communicating internally and externally regarding Wildfire Season status
- Ensuring electrical system reliability and consistent energy delivery

3 Terms & Acronyms

3.1 Defined Acronyms

Table 1 lists the acronyms used in this procedure.

Table 1: Defined Acronyms

Acronym	Full Term	Definition
DNR	Department of Natural Resources	Washington State agency responsible for wildfire protection and outdoor burning regulation on state and private forested lands.
EFR	Electric First Response	PSE's electric field response personnel, including Troublemen, who perform patrols, respond to faults, and support de-energization and restoration during elevated critical fire weather events.
ERC	Energy Release Component	A fire weather index reflecting the available energy per unit area in flammable material.

Acronym	Full Term	Definition
FPIP	Fire Potential Index Percentile	Technosylva-derived metric capturing local environmental fire risk variability.
IFPL	Industrial Fire Precaution Level	Washington State DNR fire restriction levels for motorized equipment use on forested lands.
NFDRS	National Fire Danger Rating System	Multi-agency system for communicating fire danger to the public.
NWCC	Northwest Interagency Coordination Center	Regional coordination center for wildfire suppression, resource management, and wildfire intelligence.
PSA	Predictive Service Area	Wildland fire fuels and fire behavior forecast areas established by the NWCC.
SCADA	Supervisory Control and Data Acquisition	A control system used to remotely monitor and control electrical system equipment.
SME	Subject Matter Expert	An individual with specialized knowledge relevant to a given task or process.
WLM	Wildfire Liaison Manager	PSE personnel who monitor wildfire indicators, maintain external agency coordination, and provide situational intelligence and subject-matter support to operational decision-making.
WRM	Wildfire Risk Management	The PSE business unit that is responsible for wildfire risk monitoring, analysis, and coordination of wildfire mitigation programs across PSE's service territory.

3.2 Defined Terms

Table 2 defines the key terms used in this procedure.

Table 2: Defined Terms

Term	Definition
PSE Wildfire Season	The period of elevated fire weather risk annually declared by PSE when conditions and vegetation moisture levels create elevated wildfire risk, requiring enhanced operational mitigations.
PSE Wildfire Season Declaration	The formal designation action that activates, modifies, or rescinds PSE Wildfire Season Status and the associated Seasonal Readiness Mitigations.
PSE Wildfire Season Status	The current declared system status relative to Wildfire Season readiness. Valid statuses are “Active” (season declared and mitigations in effect) and “Closed” (season rescinded and standard operations resumed).
Seasonal Readiness Mitigations	Operational measures implemented during Active PSE Wildfire Season periods.
Wildfire Priority	A PSE designation applied to specific transmission lines and distribution circuits located in areas with elevated wildfire risk.

4 Roles & Responsibilities

The specific roles and responsibilities of critical functions in the decision process are identified in the RACI Matrix below (Table 3).

R = Responsible: The person(s) who owns and completes the project, task, or work.

A = Accountable: The person(s) who signs off on the work and who has final sign-off authority and is responsible for outcomes.

C = Consulted: The person(s) who has the ability or knowledge needed to complete the work. These are Subject Matter Experts (SME), or anyone else who can contribute consultatively to the task.

I = Informed: The person(s) who must be kept informed of the work but not necessarily consulted.

R	Responsible	A	Accountable	C	Consulted	I	Informed

Table 3: RACI Matrix

Position	Monitor Conditions	Facilitate Decision to Change Status	Approve Declaration	Implement Declaration
Primary Monitoring & Risk Assessment				
Meteorologist	R	R	I	I
Wildfire Liaison Manager(s) (WLM)	R	R	I	R
System Operations				
System Operations Supervisor	I	I	I	R
System Operations Manager	C	C	I	C
Load Office				
Load Office Supervisor	I	I	I	R
Load Office Manager	C	C	I	C
Electric Operations — Operational Management				
Manager of Electric Operations Substations	I	I	I	C
Manager Electric Operations **Electric First Response** (**EFR**)	I	C	I	R
Supervisor of Energy Operations	I	C	I	R
Electric First Responder Supervisor(s)	C	I	I	R
Director of Electric Operations	I	C	C	I
Director of Electric System Control	I	C	C	I

Position	Monitor Conditions	Facilitate Decision to Change Status	Approve Declaration	Implement Declaration
Wildfire Risk Management (WRM)				
WRM Manager	C	C	I	C
WRM Senior Program Manager	I	I	I	I
WRM Communications	I	I	I	R
Emergency Management & Corporate Functions				
Director of Communications	I	I	I	I
Director of Safety	I	I	I	I
Director of Gas Operations	I	I	I	I
Director of Generation	I	I	I	I
Executive Approval Authority				
Vice President of Gas & Electric Operations	C	C	C	A
Senior Vice President of Energy Operations	I	I	A	I

NOTE Each position may take additional actions and communications specific to their role, team, or position in the company related to implementing this procedure.

5 Prerequisites & Requirements

The following prerequisites must be confirmed before initiating this procedure:

- All parties identified in Section 4 must be familiar with this procedure and understand their roles and responsibilities.
- The WLMs and Meteorologist must have current access to the Technosylva Wildfire Analyst/Fire Risk application.
- WLMs must have access to the current, approved PSE Wildfire Season Declaration Form.
- WLMs must have write access to the Wildfire Mitigation Folder.
- WLMs must have current contact information for all parties identified in the RACI Matrix (Section 4).

6 Procedure

The Meteorologist and WLMs monitor conditions throughout the year and initiate the formal decision process to change PSE Wildfire Season Status when conditions warrant. Status changes are minimized

where conditions allow, but local conditions may require additional adjustments. Refer to Section 8.2 for the intelligence sources used to inform recommendations.

Figure 1 summarizes the declaration process from monitoring through implementation. The sections that follow define each step.

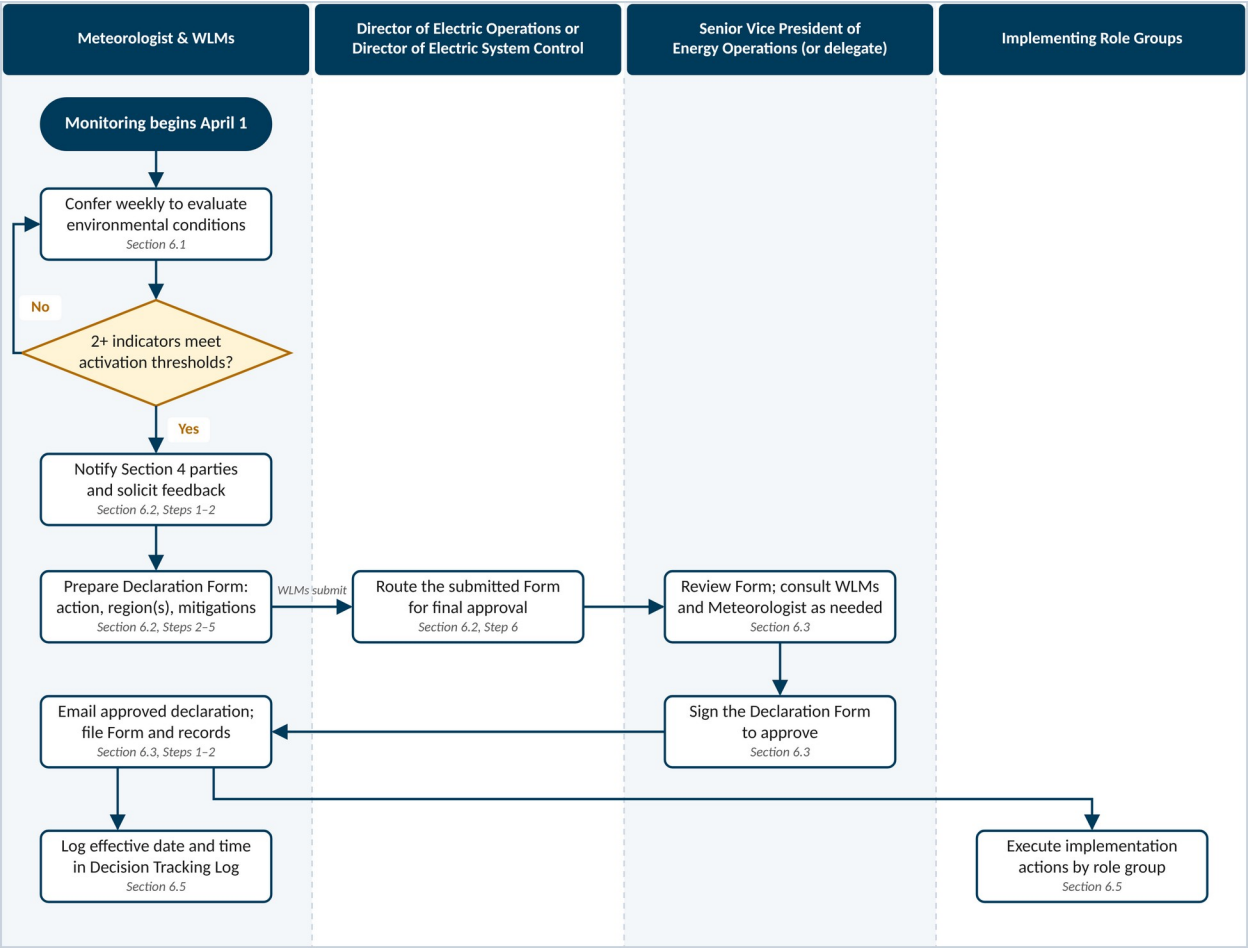


Figure 1: Declaration Process Overview

6.1 Season Monitoring

Beginning April 1 each year, the WLMs and Meteorologist confer weekly to evaluate environmental conditions until PSE Wildfire Season Status is declared Closed for the season. When two or more seasonal indicators (Section 6.1.1) meet or exceed their activation thresholds, the WLMs and Meteorologist initiate the Declaration Recommendation process outlined in Section 6.2. If thresholds are not met, monitoring continues on the weekly schedule.

6.1.1 Seasonal Indicators

A combination of intelligence sources, including but not limited to the indicators in Table 4 below, informs PSE Wildfire Season recommendations. All thresholds are evaluated independently for Western Washington and Eastern Washington. Indices trending above their activation thresholds support

activating or augmenting Wildfire Season actions; indices trending below their rescission thresholds support rescinding. Additional details on each intelligence source are provided in Section 8.2.

Table 4: Seasonal Indicators and Thresholds

Intelligence/Index	Threshold — Supports Activation	Threshold — Supports Rescission
Current Climatological Outlooks	Significant deviation from normal conditions	Near-seasonal normal or improving conditions
Drought Outlooks	Worsening drought conditions	Improving or no drought conditions
Nighttime Humidity Recovery Forecast	Poor or declining recovery indicating fuel drying	Consistent recovery indicating fuel moisture improvement
Weather Systems of Concern (e.g., frontal passages, east-wind events)	Increased potential for fire-conducive weather events	Low potential for fire-conducive weather events
Seasonality (Burn Period)	Daylight hours increasing (spring/summer)	Daylight hours decreasing (fall)
Technosylva **Fire Potential Index Percentile** (**FPIP**) (4-Day Forecast)	Forecasted consistently at or above 80th percentile (Moderate or higher)	Consistently below 80th percentile (Very Low or Low)
10-Day Predicted **Energy Release Component** (**ERC**)/F100 (Fuel Model Y)	**Predictive Service Area** (**PSA**) ERC at or forecasted above 85th percentile	PSA ERC consistently below 85th percentile
7-Day Fire Potential	Moderate or higher	Low
National Fire Danger Rating System (**NFDRS**)	Increasing to Moderate or higher	Decreasing to Moderate or lower
Industrial Fire Precaution Level (**IFPL**)	Level 1 or higher	Level 2 or lower

6.2 Declaration Recommendation

When the WLMs and Meteorologist recommend a Wildfire Season Status change, they execute the following steps:

1. WLMs notify all parties identified in Section 4 that a declaration recommendation is being prepared and solicit feedback at that time.
2. WLMs and the Meteorologist gather feedback from Consulted parties and prepare the PSE Wildfire Season Declaration Form, documenting the indices and criteria supporting the recommendation.
3. On the Form, WLMs specify the recommended declaration action (select one):
   - Activating – Declaring “Active PSE Wildfire Season”
   - Modifying – Adjusting mitigations to meet current conditions (during previously declared Active PSE Wildfire Season)
   - Rescinding – Declaring “Closed PSE Wildfire Season”

4. On the Form, WLMs specify the applicable region(s) (select all that apply):
   - Western Washington
   - Eastern Washington
5. On the Form, WLMs identify the Seasonal Readiness Mitigations to be implemented or modified based on current conditions. These actions may include any of the following or additional actions:
   - Reclosing devices – including relays and schemes that cannot be remotely operated, are disabled on Wildfire Priority transmission lines
   - De-energizing Wildfire Priority transmission line segments with normal open points
   - Reclosing disabled on Wildfire Priority distribution circuit fuse savers, trip savers, and non-**Supervisory Control and Data Acquisition** (**SCADA**) reclosers
   - Field resources placed in an elevated state of readiness in designated areas, including expanded hours of real-time coverage and fire-suppression tools and equipment placed in service
   - Key messages developed and distributed to internal stakeholders, led by Wildfire Risk Management Communications team
6. WLMs submit the completed Form to the Director of Electric Operations or the Director of Electric System Control for routing to the Senior Vice President of Energy Operations, or delegate, for final approval.

6.3 Declaration Approval

The Senior Vice President of Energy Operations, or delegate, reviews the submitted Form and consults with the WLMs and Meteorologist if additional information is needed to support the recommendation. The Senior Vice President of Energy Operations, or delegate, approves the recommendation by signing the PSE Wildfire Season Declaration Form once any outstanding questions have been resolved.

Upon approval, the WLM executes the following steps:

1. Email the approved PSE Wildfire Season Declaration to all parties identified in Section 4.
2. Electronically file the approved Form and all decision-related correspondence in the 2026 PSE Wildfire Season Declaration Documentation folder.

6.4 Declaration Modification

During a declared Active PSE Wildfire Season, mitigations may be modified as conditions warrant — for example, when conditions moderate and reduced staffing hours may be appropriate. All modification requests are directed to the WLMs, who evaluate and initiate the modification process.

Modifications follow the Declaration Recommendation process (Section 6.2) and the Declaration Approval process (Section 6.3). Full season monitoring criteria (Section 6.1) should be considered when evaluating modification requests but do not require a full restart of the monitoring cycle.

6.5 Implementation

Upon receipt of the approved declaration, each role group executes its assigned implementation actions in the sequence listed in Table 5.

Table 5: Implementation Actions by Role Group

Step	Action
System Operations and Load Office	
1	Implement the Wildfire Response Operating Procedure.
2	Update system settings per the approved declaration.
Electric First Responders	
1	Update system settings for non-SCADA devices, as directed by System Operations.
2	Implement all mitigations identified on the PSE Wildfire Season Declaration Form, including staffing adjustments and fire-suppression equipment readiness.
WLMs	
1	Document the effective date and time in the Wildfire Critical Decision Tracking Log, located in the Wildfire Mitigation Folder.
2	Confirm that all record-keeping complies with applicable PSE policies and procedures.
WRM Communications	
1	Develop and distribute internal and external messaging and talking points for external-facing staff and all-employee communication channels.
2	Support engagements with communities, stakeholders, and partners as appropriate.

> **NOTE** Full implementation of all Wildfire Season system mitigations may require up to 7 days following declaration. Operational teams must account for this lead time when planning communications and field readiness.

7 Documentation & Records

WLMs are responsible for maintaining all completed forms and decision records in the 2026 PSE Wildfire Season Declaration Documentation folder. All forms and decision-related correspondence must be retained in accordance with PSE's Records and Information Management Policy.

8 References

8.1 PSE Forms, Documents, and Resources

- PSE Wildfire Season Declaration Form
- PSE Wildfire Operating Plan
- Records and Information Management Policy
- Wildfire Critical Decision Tracking Log
- Wildfire Mitigation Folder

- Wildfire Response Operating Procedure
- 2026 PSE Wildfire Season Declaration Documentation Folder

8.2 Wildfire Intelligence References

The intelligence sources listed below are examples of products used to inform PSE Wildfire Season recommendations. The Meteorologist will identify and use additional sources as appropriate. Threshold values for each indicator are documented in Table 4 (Section 6.1.1).

> **NOTE** WLMs must document all sources used to support the declaration recommendation on the PSE Wildfire Season Declaration Form.

8.2.1 Weather Analysis

PSE's Meteorologist informs decisions using various forecast products and indicators, including:

- Current climatological outlooks
- Drought outlooks
- Nighttime humidity recovery forecasts
- Cold front passage potential
- Seasonality consideration

8.2.2 Technosylva Analytics

Source: *PSE Technosylva Wildfire Analyst/Fire Risk Application*

The FPIP 4-day forecast is evaluated using the Technosylva application. FPIP captures local environmental variability and identifies conditions that are relative to local norms. This percentile approach ensures that the index remains sensitive to regional climatological differences while identifying locally anomalous conditions.

Criteria: FPIP forecasted consistently below the 80th percentile (Very Low or Low) supports lowering fire season designation. FPIP forecasted consistently at or above the 80th percentile (Moderate or higher) supports elevating fire season designation.

8.2.3 10-Day Predicted ERC and F100 (Fuel Model Y)

Source: 10-Day Predicted ERC and F100 (Fuel Model Y)

This product analyzes ERC and 100-hour fuel moisture compared to historical averages and predicts ERC trends based on forecasted conditions. ERCs are affected by forecasted weather that either increases or decreases moisture.

Criteria: ERCs above the 85th percentile indicate fuel conditions receptive to fire. Higher ERCs indicate fuels will burn more readily and intensely.

8.2.4 7-Day Fire Potential

Source: Pacific Northwest 7-Day Significant Fire Potential

This product considers the risk of new large fires, taking into account fire weather, fuel conditions, and environmental or social risk factors.

8.2.5 NWCC Northwest Preparedness Level

Source: Northwest Interagency Coordination Center

The **Northwest Interagency Coordination Center** (**NWCC**) Preparedness Level and Morning Briefing indicate ongoing fire suppression resource commitment and overall operational tempo in the Pacific Northwest.

8.2.6 Fire Danger Rating

Source: Washington State DNR Fire Danger Map

The NFDRS communicates fire danger to the public and is tied to outdoor burning restrictions. Ratings are set through coordination with multiple agencies and posted on the Washington State **Department of Natural Resources** (**DNR**) website.

Ratings are interpreted as follows:

- **Low:** High confidence of little to no fire risk
- **Moderate:** Some risk of fire
- **High or above:** Elevated concern for new fire start potential with increased resistance to control

8.2.7 Industrial Fire Precaution Level (IFPL)

Source: Washington State DNR Industrial Fire Precaution Levels

IFPL levels are set weekly by the Washington DNR during fire danger coordination calls and apply to motorized equipment use on forested lands. DNR Summer Fire Rules state that from April 15–October 15 (or later if fire danger warrants), IFPL requirements must be followed.

Levels are interpreted as follows:

- **Level 1:** Low risk of fire
- **Level 2:** Increased concern during heat of day (partial shutdown hours)
- **Level 3 or 4:** High risk of fires starting from equipment

Appendix A – Revision History

Table 6 records the revision history of this procedure.

Table 6: Revision History

Revision Date	Revision Number	Summary of Changes	Changes Made By
06-10-2026	01	Initial release	D. Porter